



Recruiting Staff

To find employees with the right skills, knowledge, and attitude for your business, you need to plan the recruitment process in detail—from advertising the role and creating a job description to interviewing and making a decision.

Hiring effectively

Hiring the right person is a time-consuming process, so it is essential to plan ahead. Think about the role and the qualities of the person who is most likely to succeed at it. Having the right skills

is key, but characteristics, such as the ability to work in a team or use one's own initiative, may be equally important. If someone has to work alone in an office, for example, they will need to be confident enough to handle queries without deferring

to someone else. Experience of a similar business is also invaluable, affording insights into different ways of doing things. Looking at advertisements for similar jobs will give you an idea of the typical salary and the key skills for the role.

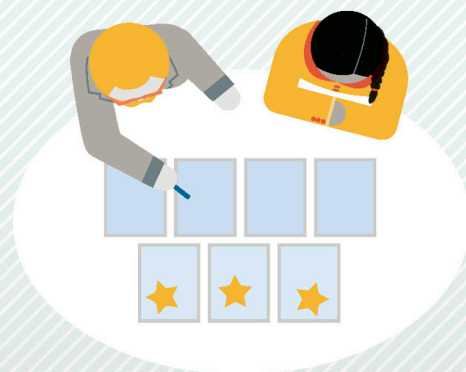
Finding the right person

A job description will help you attract and assess candidates and decide who to interview. Planning the interview in detail will guide you toward choosing the right person.

Creating a job description

This is an essential step in the recruitment process, as it determines which applicants you will attract. An effective description will provide candidates with a clear picture of the job and the specific skills and knowledge required.

- › **Define the job title clearly**, including how the role fits into the wider business.
- › **Describe the main duties** and responsibilities.
- › **Outline skills and experience**, plus any qualifications required, being reasonable in your expectations.
- › **Set out the terms of employment** in detail, such as hours, salary, location, sick pay, and vacation allowance.



Reviewing applications

The job description provides a guide for assessing candidates. Use the skills and qualities you have listed to decide whether candidates meet your needs.

- › **Divide applications** into three groups: likely, not sure, and unlikely.
- › **Focus on skills** and experience rather than personal details such as someone's name, which may be an unconscious bias.
- › **Look out** for someone who has experience in the area you need but will still be learning in the role.
- › **Make notes** as these will help form questions at the interview stage.
- › **Keep a record** of candidates who are not right for this job but might suit a future role.